

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Survey

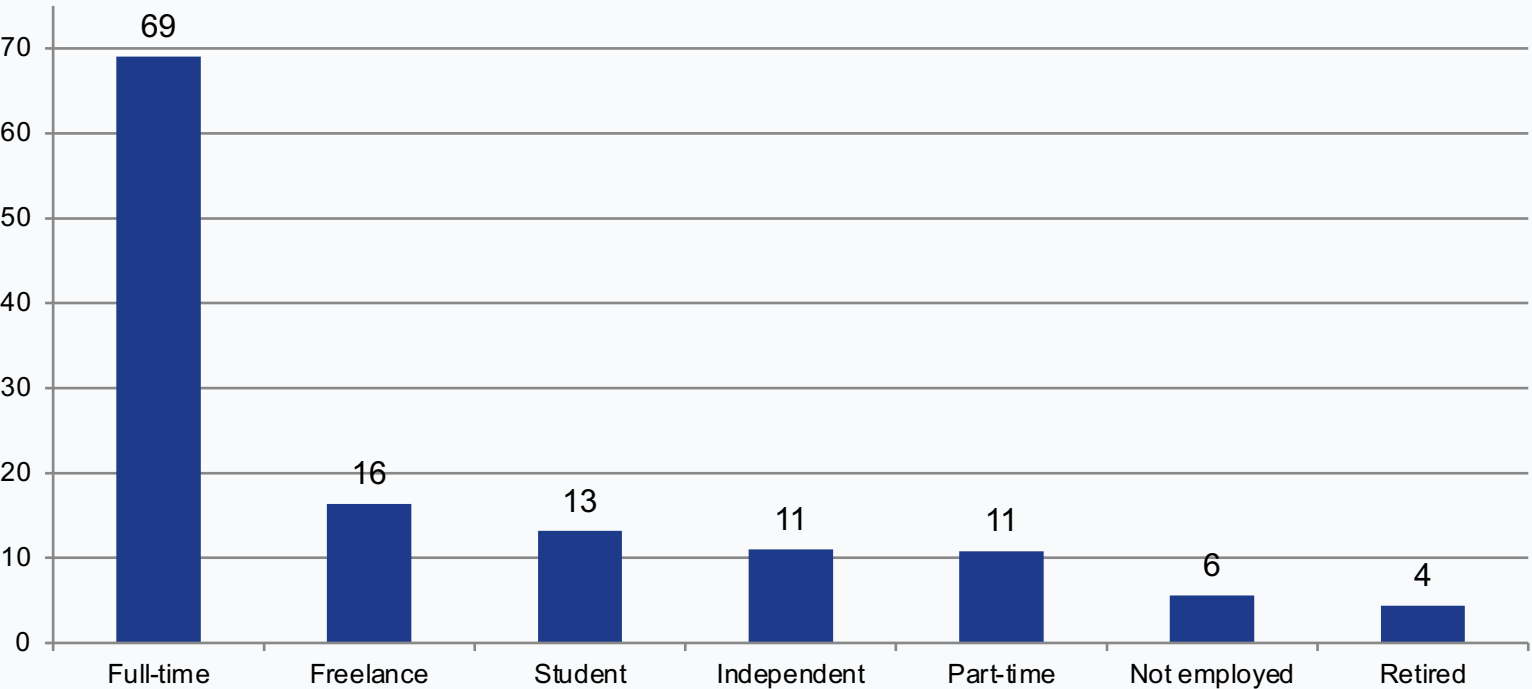
65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

Audience: Engineering managers and HR leaders

Source: Stack Overflow Developer Survey 2024

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

Global employment mix vs. U.S. year-over-year shift



U.S. Full-time Employment

2023: 69.0%

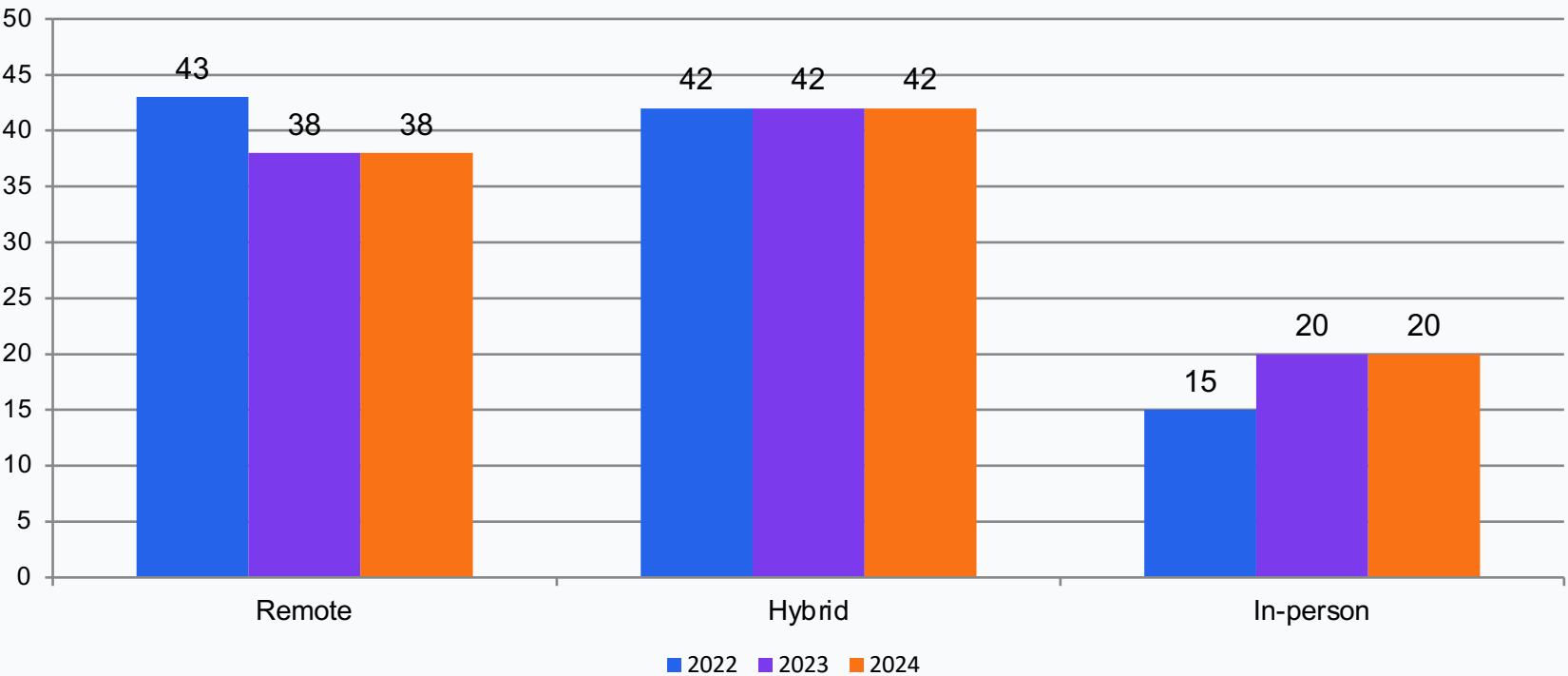
2024: 64.8%

Change: -4.2 pts

Working categories total 84% globally (full-time + freelance + part-time).

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

Three-year work environment shift (2022–2024)

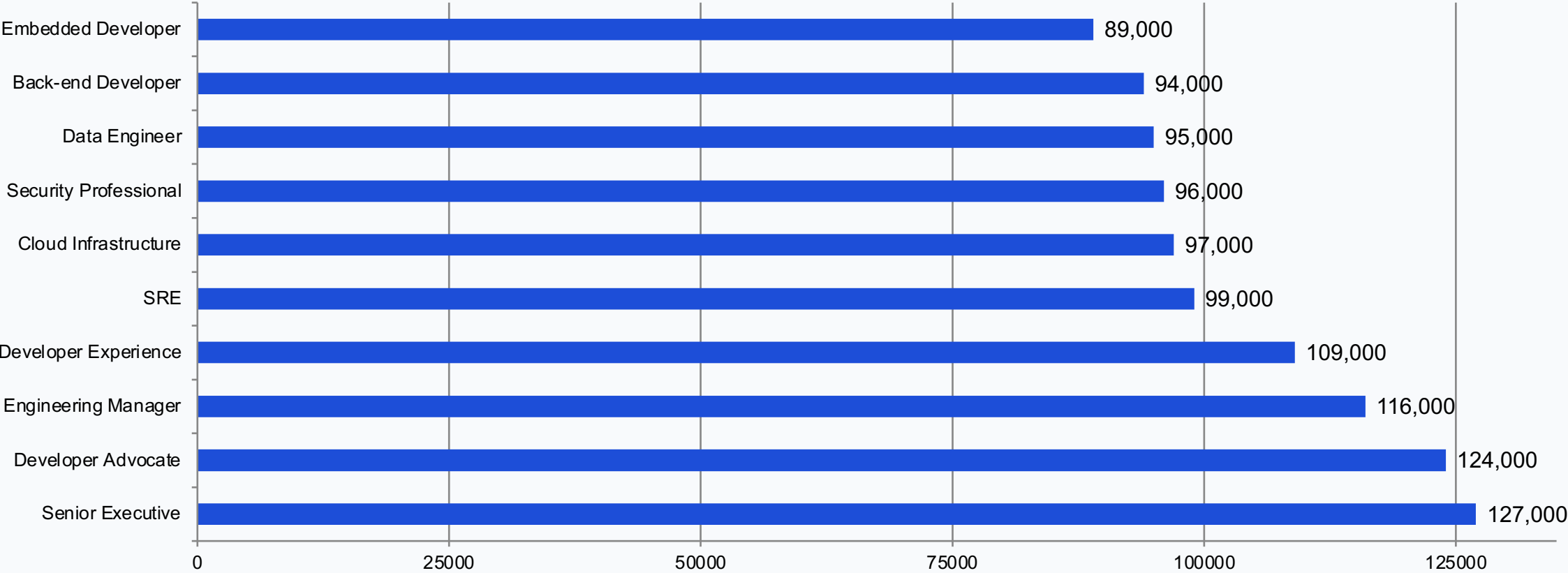


Signal

In-person rose from 15% (2022) to 20% (2024), while hybrid remains stable at 42%.

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

Median salary by developer type (top 10) — reference: figure_1.jpg



Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries

Median salary vs. average experience by developer type — reference: figure_2.jpg

Notable points

- Senior roles cluster in upper-right
- Student outlier near \$15K
- Strong positive pay-experience trend

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K

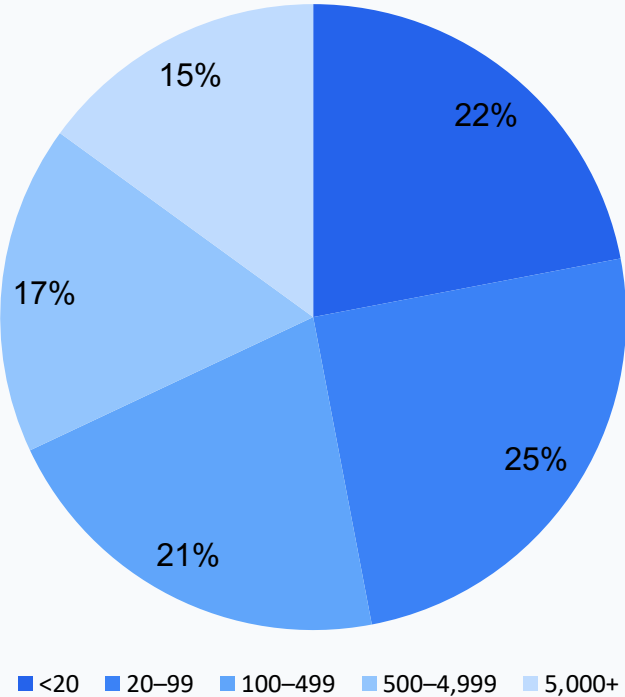
Median salary vs. experience by language — reference: figure_3.jpg

Callouts

Top: Erlang \$97K, Clojure \$95K,
Elixir \$93K
Low: Dart \$44K, Prolog \$43K,
PHP \$49K
Average salary range ~ \$10K
lower vs. 2023

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Company-size context and technology purchasing influence



Purchasing Influence

62% of developers influence technology purchases.

60% prefer a build-and-buy approach.

Top evaluation actions:

- Start free trial (75%)
- Ask other developers (73%)

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

1. Full-time employment is softening; keep contractor and freelance pipelines active.
2. In-person mandates are rising, but hybrid remains dominant at 42%.
3. DevRel, leadership, and reliability-focused roles command premium pay.
4. Language specialization correlates with pay; niche ecosystems often cost more.
5. Most developers influence purchasing decisions — engage practitioners directly.

Benchmark hiring bands quarterly and tailor retention packages by role criticality.